

Topic 9: AI for Summarisation and Research

9.1 Document Summarisation

- Paste any document and specify the summary type: '3-bullet summary', 'key decisions only', 'executive summary'
- Audience-specific: 'Summarise this technical paper for a marketing manager with no technical background'
- Structured extraction: 'From this document, extract: main argument, key evidence, methodology, limitations, conclusions'
- Multi-document: 'Summarise these 3 articles and highlight where they agree and where they contradict each other'
- Claude (claude.ai) is particularly strong for very long documents due to its 200k token context window

9.2 Research Synthesis

- Literature-style review: 'Summarise the key findings from these abstracts into a coherent narrative by theme'
- Comparison tables: 'Create a table comparing these 5 studies: authors, methodology, sample size, key finding, limitation'
- Gap identification: 'Based on these summaries, what research questions are NOT answered by current work?'
- Counter-argument generation: 'What are the strongest objections to the main argument of this paper?'
- Best tool for document-grounded research synthesis: NotebookLM (notebooklm.google.com) -- citations link to source

9.3 Competitive Research

- Company analysis: 'Analyse the positioning, messaging, and apparent strengths of this company based on their website: [URL]'
- SWOT: 'Conduct a SWOT analysis of this competitor based on the following information I have gathered: [paste data]'
- Feature comparison: 'Build a feature comparison table for these 4 products based on their documentation: [paste links or content]'
- Market gaps: 'What needs of buyers in this market appear to be underserved by these 3 competitors?'
- Caveat: AI analysis is based on what you provide and public information -- always verify with primary sources

9.4 Research Workflow

- Stage 1 -- Broad overview: Perplexity AI for a cited overview of the topic
 - Stage 2 -- Deep dive: NotebookLM to chat with specific papers, reports, or documents you have collected
 - Stage 3 -- Synthesis: Claude (large context) to combine findings from multiple summarised sources
 - Stage 4 -- Validation: manually verify every statistic and factual claim against the original primary source
 - Stage 5 -- Output: ask AI to format your validated research into a structured brief, report, or slide deck outline
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